



Google's Router- OnHub

Google launched its new Wi-Fi router called OnHub and it's priced at \$199.
<http://dgit.in/googleonhub>

Faces on Watch

Google just made Android Wear a lot more useful and user friendly with new interactive faces.
<http://dgit.in/andwrfaces>

Industry Connect



Software Asset Management is here to stay

We have a chat with Vikas Bhonsle, CEO, Crayon Software Experts India Pvt Ltd. about the SAM industry in India

◀ Vikas Bhonsle, CEO, Crayon Software Experts India Pvt Ltd

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1 Crayon Software Experts entered the Indian market only last year while it has been active globally for over a decade.

Vikas Bhonsle: Crayon was founded in Norway, 13 years ago. As the business grew, the company naturally expanded into the nearby Nordic markets as culture and business practice was most closely aligned there and then into the wider western European markets. Organic expansion also needed both cost and time. Then we had to generate enough return for expansion. It was also important to find the right leaders to drive the wider business. Our entrance into India should be seen in the context of this expanding continuum - after all we entered India at about the same time as market entries in SEA, MEA and much earlier than the US - and no one would say the US market is either small or insignificant. As we continue to expand, people should not be surprised to see us enter into other important markets in SEA and in Latin America.

1 With plenty of players in the software licensing market currently, what does Crayon Software Experts aim to do different to gain market share?

Vikas: The tech industry is always in flux. Frequent new products and category

innovation define and redefine the sector's constantly shifting landscape. But lately we've seen even greater instability than usual, and it has begun to affect the temperament of software companies themselves. At Crayon we believe in doing things differently. We would like to be the differentiator.

To begin with, we believe we are uniquely positioned as we cater to the entire life cycle management of the software assets. Whether the licensing is perpetual or on subscription, we have solutions for the same. We also offer consulting and deployment services for various technologies. And we are the largest and fastest growing SOFTWARE ASSET MANAGEMENT consultants across the globe. Our world class framework on SAM helps build process, policies and drive greater usage of assets for our customers. We believe we can serve all the needs of our customers under one roof. And yes, being a very young company in India we have no legacy and we are building our business philosophy on the cloud first, mobile first era that aligns ourselves beautifully to the landscape.

Crayon has a Pan-India presence with expertise in Licensing, SAM, Software Distribution, Deployment and Consulting.

1 Does India exhibit the same ratio between different revenue sources as

developed markets? Or does it favour one segment only?

Vikas: When I look at my different lines of business, I would say that the major business comes from licensing, followed by SAM and consulting. However, we have been conscious enough to drive a high mix of cloud by ensuring we build value for our customers through our expertise and skill. Our cloud mix is higher than 50 per cent on the licensing side.

When one compares this with the developed markets - I would say the ratios are similar. It is a function of market maturity as well. Eg. The developed markets have a far higher acceptance and adoption of SAM as compared to India. Hence, the business is more robust on SAM in those markets but even then the ratios are fairly similar.

1 With more and more global companies gaining a foothold in India and also making it simple to obtain licenses directly, would you consider that a worrying trend?

Vikas: Competition is always welcome and is a sign of a growing and maturing market. For a vast country like India, I believe that more global companies will only increase the capacity to address more customers, bring best practices to India and thus improve the overall quality of solutions delivered to the end customer. This is very healthy. **1**